

Why Shell Türkiye’s B2C Share Hit an All-Time High in the May 2026 EPDK Report

Prepared: 27 July 2026 Scope: Shell & Turcas Petrol A.Ş. (STAŞ) retail (B2C / istasyon) market share in Türkiye, based on the EPDK Petrol Piyasası May 2026 monthly sector report (published ~20 July 2026) and the preceding monthly reports. Method note: direct access to epdk.gov.tr and several sector sites was blocked in this research environment; figures were triangulated across multiple independent press reports of the official bulletins. Verify key numbers against the EPDK PDF before external use.

1. Executive Summary — the one-paragraph answer

Shell’s record B2C share in May 2026 is **not primarily a “Shell did something new in May” story — it is a “the market came to Shell” story, amplified by real Shell execution and competitor disarray**. May 2026 was the most gasoline-skewed, most retail-skewed month in the modern Turkish fuel record: gasoline sales rose **+11.4% y/y (521,965 t)** while diesel collapsed **–15.7% (1,960,637 t)**, a record nine-day Kurban Bayramı (23–31 May) produced all-time road-travel records and **827 million litres** of pump sales in ten days, and pump prices were *falling* into the holiday. Shell is Türkiye’s **#1 gasoline seller (~30% of national benzin)** with the **highest-throughput station network in the sector (~2.1–2.5× sales per station vs average)** — exactly the profile that gains when the demand mix swings from commercial diesel to holiday gasoline. On top of that mechanical mix effect, three competitors were structurally impaired during the data month (TP Petrol Dağıtım’s dealer network in regulatory free-agency, Balpet delicensed, Petrol Ofisi mid-way through digesting 770 ex-BP stations), and Shell’s own commercial engine (fastest dealer recruitment, loyalty and fill-up campaigns, premium V-Power positioning, top customer-satisfaction scores) converted the traffic into share. Roughly, we estimate **+0.5–1.0 pp of the gain is mix-mechanical** and the rest is genuine within-product share capture. Part of the record is therefore **seasonal/one-off (bayram, TP window)** and will partially revert in June–July data; part is **structural (hybrid-driven gasoline growth, diesel decline, competitor consolidation)** and should keep Shell’s B2C share on a rising trend.

2. What the May 2026 EPDK report actually shows (market level)

Metric (May 2026)	Value	y/y
Benzin (gasoline) domestic sales	521,965 t	+11.43%
Motorin (diesel) domestic sales	1,960,637 t	–15.73%
Total petroleum product sales	2,625,231 t	–10.49%
Diesel-type imports	845,903 t	–27.0%
LPG / otogaz	336,830 t / 288,624 t	+1.4% / +4.5%

Two derived facts matter more than any single number:

- Gasoline’s weight in the white-product barrel jumped from ~16.8% (May 2025) to ~21.0% (May 2026)** — a +4.2 pp mix swing in a single year, by far the most gasoline-heavy month in the data. (Implied May 2025 base: benzin ~468k t, motorin ~2,327k t.)

2. **The decline was concentrated in diesel/B2B, not in retail.** Benzin is sold almost entirely through station pumps (~99.5% per EPDK channel data), while roughly a quarter-plus of motorin goes to B2B channels (serbest kullanıcı, commercial/fleet, wholesale). A -15.7% diesel month with industry contracting (Q1 2026 industrial GDP -0.8%), freight corridors disrupted by the Iran war, and agriculture weak is above all a **B2B demand collapse**. The B2C pool held up far better — and in bayram week actually boomed.

Month-by-month trend into May (EPDK monthlies):

2026	Benzin	y/y	Motorin	y/y
Jan	428,812 t	+9.1%	1,861,387 t	-1.7%
Feb	417,803 t	+17.7%	1,834,490 t	+1.1%
Mar	480,047 t	+8.1%	2,220,838 t	+8.1%*
Apr	466,449 t	+6.1%	2,004,871 t	-4.1%
May	521,965 t	+11.4%	1,960,637 t	-15.7%

* March inflated by pre-buying ahead of war-driven price hikes and holiday timing.

Every month of 2026 repeats the same signature — gasoline up, diesel flat-to-down — and May is the extreme print of the series. **Whoever leads gasoline retail leads May.** That is Shell.

3. Shell's position going into May

Shell's product mix is uniquely gasoline- and retail-tilted among the majors:

Latest public data	Shell	Rank	Leaders
Benzin, Mar 2026	143,051 t ≈ 29.8% of national gasoline	#1	Opet 131,032 t; PO 115,826 t
Benzin, Apr 2026	~140.7M litres/month	#1	—
Motorin, Mar 2026	370,000 t ≈ 16.7%	#3	PO 606,300 t; Opet 409,900 t
Total white products, Apr 2026	19.49%	#3	PO 26.34%; Opet 19.69%

Benchmark share history (to validate “highest of all time”):

Period	Shell share	Basis
2023 (annual)	19.71%	total fuel, #2 (a <i>declining</i> year for Shell per EPDK 2023 report)
2024 (annual)	~20.1%	retail station sales, sector leader claim
Dec 2024 / Oct 2025	~21.5%	“canopy” (station B2B+B2C) share, self-reported leader
May 2025 (monthly)	~18.8–19.8%	total white products, #3
Apr 2026 (monthly)	19.49%	total white products, #3

So Shell's pre-May retail-share ceiling was roughly **20–21.5%**. Nothing in the record contradicts a May 2026 all-time high; every documented driver points to it. Note that no press outlet had republished the May distributor table as of 27 July — the record figure you are looking at exists (for now) only in the EPDK PDF and internal reads of it.

The network math: Shell runs ~1,250 stations vs Petrol Ofisi's ~2,700 and Opet's ~1,800, yet holds ~30% of gasoline — because its per-station throughput is ~2.1–2.5× the sector average, its network over-indexes on metropolitan and intercity-corridor sites, and it has been the sector's fastest dealer recruiter (+50 new dealers since Nov 2023). This is precisely the network shape that captures holiday highway traffic.

4. The five drivers of the May record, ranked

Driver 1 — The gasoline/diesel mix shock (mechanical; largest single factor)

Shell's B2C share is a weighted average of its ~30% gasoline share and its (much lower) ~17–20% retail-diesel share. When gasoline's weight in the retail barrel jumps, Shell's blended share rises **with Shell doing nothing at all**.

Illustrative bridge (assumptions stated, verify against the PDF): applying EPDK channel weights (benzin ~99.5% via stations, motorin ~73%), gasoline's weight in the *retail* barrel rose from ~21.6% (May 2025) to ~26.7% (May 2026). Holding Shell's product-level shares constant at ~30% (benzin) and ~19% (retail motorin), the blended retail share moves from ~21.4% to ~21.9% — **≈ +0.5–0.6 pp of B2C share from mix alone**, before any actual share capture. The same arithmetic on total white products gives ~+0.5 pp (19.0% → ~19.5%). Any print meaningfully above that (e.g. 22%+) implies Shell *also* gained within products — see Drivers 2–5.

This driver is structural, not one-off: hybrids (847k cars, 4.7% of the parc, all burning gasoline) plus a gasoline car parc that grew from 3.2M (2020) to 5.55M (Jun 2026) guarantee gasoline keeps outgrowing diesel. Diesel is 6–8% of new-car sales; hybrid+EV passed 51%. **The mix tailwind blows in Shell's favor every month from here — May just blew hardest.**

Driver 2 — A record nine-day Kurban Bayramı sat almost entirely inside May (seasonal; the amplifier)

- Holiday window **23–31 May 2026** (arefe 26 May, bayram 27–30 May, plus 1.5 days administrative leave) — a nine-day national holiday, fully inside the May data month.
- All-time mobility records: **29.3M vehicles** through tolled highways/bridges; 18.5M on KGM highways; Yavuz Sultan Selim Bridge's highest single day ever (189,004 vehicles, 22 May); record European border-gate crossings on 30 May.
- **827,272,614 litres** of gasoline+diesel sold in 22–31 May (₺54.1bn). During the holiday window the national sales mix shifted to **~33% gasoline vs ~20% on a normal day**.
- Holiday demand is almost purely **B2C passenger-car, highway-corridor, big-brand demand** — while B2B diesel demand (freight, industry, agriculture) simultaneously cratered. The retail channel's weight in the whole market surged, and within retail, the segments where Shell over-indexes (intercity corridors, premium V-Power, loyalty-carrying urban customers) surged most.
- Pricing helped rather than hurt: diesel was cut **5.52 TL/L on 9 May**, a further gasoline cut landed on bayram eve, and eşel-mobil ÖTV support (up to 13.90 TL/L diesel / 10.59 TL/L gasoline waived) kept pump prices ~64–67 TL/L — falling prices into a holiday maximize discretionary travel.

Driver 3 — Three competitors were impaired during exactly this window (share redistribution)

- **TP Petrol Dağıtım (Türkiye Petrolleri, ~4.9% share / ~592 dealers a year earlier):** criminal investigation over an 18,476-tonne fuel shortfall (>₺1bn), executives jailed. EPDK board decisions 13916 (3 Nov 2025)

and 14415 (26 Mar 2026) allowed TP dealers to **temporarily sell under other distributors' licenses until 30 June 2026** — no exit fees. Through the entire May data month, a ~5%-share network was in free agency and its volumes were being booked under rival flags. Which majors captured how much is not public; given Shell's recruitment record, some accrual to Shell is likely, and even PO/Opet-bound volume mechanically lifts every remaining player's share as TP's own line collapses.

- **Balpet:** distributor license canceled 13 Feb 2025 (smuggling-law court ruling) — another mid-tier network's volume permanently redistributed into 2025–26 comparisons.
- **Petrol Ofisi mid-BP-integration:** PO absorbed BP's 770 stations (dealers under PO's license from 1 March; 460+ rebranded; completion due 1 Nov 2026) and has said it will shed overlapping sites. Rebranding churn of this scale historically leaks fuel volume and dealers at the margin; ex-BP premium-brand customers are a natural V-Power/Shell audience. (Direct evidence of ex-BP dealers moving to Shell was **not** found — treat as plausible, unproven.)
- Background: the intensifying illegal-fuel crackdown (242,500 L seized in İstanbul in Q1 alone; the 23 June TMSF mega-operation came just after the May window) squeezes the untaxed fringe that competes hardest against branded retail in diesel.

Driver 4 — Shell's own commercial engine (real, but the constant, not the delta)

- Fastest dealer recruiter in the sector (+50 dealers since Nov 2023); network ~1,250 stations and growing; sales per station ~2.1–2.5× sector average.
- Active spring 2026 retail stimulation: ClubSmart fill-up campaigns (chip-para/Juzdan promos, ₺350-back mechanics), the V-Power raffle, ClubSmart×CarrefourSA grocery-to-fuel points, İş Bankası Maximum and Akbank Axxess co-campaigns — all engineered to concentrate fill-ups at Shell, precisely the behavior that peaks in a holiday month. (The “Shell'de Boş Yok” ≥₺1,250-fill campaign format launched 29 May in its 2025 edition; a 2026 rerun is unconfirmed.)
- Premium mix: V-Power pricing power and Türkiye's top sector customer-satisfaction scores (KalDer) — brand preference matters most for on-highway holiday fill-ups by one-off customers.
- Organizational continuity: new CEO Oğuz Uçanlar (from 1 Jan 2026) inherited the strategy of outgoing CEO Emre Turanlı — whose promotion to run Shell's *global* licensed-markets mobility business is itself a signal of how the Türkiye retail unit was performing.

Driver 5 — B2B weakness flattered the B2C ratio (definitional)

If the metric you track is B2C share *of Shell's or the market's total*, note that May's –15.7% diesel print was driven by B2B demand destruction (industry, freight corridors –17/–48% to Iran, agriculture). A collapsing B2B denominator raises any B2C ratio. Check which definition your report uses before comparing across months: Shell's share **of the retail market** (most likely, and what this report analyzes) vs the B2C **portion of Shell's own volume** (which would rise on B2B weakness alone).

5. How much of the record is repeatable?

Component	Est. contribution	Durability
Gasoline/diesel mix shift	~+0.5–1.0 pp vs year-ago	Structural — hybrid fleet keeps growing; diesel in secular decline

Component	Est. contribution	Durability
Bayram retail surge + falling prices	material within-May boost	One-off — reverts in June data (no holiday; post-holiday lull)
TP free-agency window	unquantified, positive	Partially reverts — dealers auto-revert to TP on 1 July 2026 unless they formally switched; watch June/July tables
BP → PO churn	small, positive	Plays out through 1 Nov 2026 rebrand deadline
Shell campaigns/network	steady accrual	Durable while sustained

Expect the June 2026 print (due ~late August) to come off the May peak — no bayram (June 2025 had one, so the y/y base flips *against* retail), post-holiday demand lull, and the TP window closing. The right internal read is: **trend B2C share = structurally rising; May level = trend + ~1–2 pp of perfect-storm**. The bigger risk to H2 retail volumes is the scheduled end of eşel-mobil ÖTV support on **1 October 2026** — a pump-price step-up that will hit discretionary (B2C gasoline) demand first, even as it may further squeeze marginal competitors.

6. What to verify in the primary PDF / internally

1. The exact May 2026 distributor table (total, benzin, motorin) — no press outlet had republished it by 27 July; this analysis reconstructs drivers, not the printed figure.
2. Shell's benzin share in May specifically — if it exceeded ~30%, within-product capture was real, not just mix.
3. Whether your B2C series is “share of retail channel” or “B2C portion of Shell volume” (Section 4, Driver 5).
4. Dealer-count movements Mar–Jun 2026: how many ex-TP (and any ex-BP/Balpet) sites flagged to Shell — this determines how much of the gain survives 1 July.
5. One press pass reported alternative y/y figures for May (benzin +4.4%, motorin –2.0%) against the same tonnages; the +11.43/–15.73 set is multi-source and arithmetically consistent, but confirm against the PDF.

7. Sources (key)

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